ILLINOIS TECH

STUDENT ORGANIZATION HANDBOOK

Office of Student Life



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Office of Student Life

Mission and Vision

The Office of Student Life (OSL) is committed to fostering a student centered and transformative student life experience at Illinois Tech. Through our programs, facilities and services, the Office of Student Life aims to create a collaborative and inclusive environment that encourages innovation and excellence for all students.

Values

Innovation

- *We are a community of forward thinkers where students are encouraged to discover, create, and innovate no matter how big or small the idea.*

Collaboration

- *We believe innovation is best powered through shared knowledge. We promote teamwork and the distribution of knowledge and resources to achieve our goals.*

Inclusivity

- *We embrace members of our global community and create an environment rooted in respect, understanding, and equity for all identities.*

Excellence

- *Through our values of Innovation, Collaboration, and Inclusivity, we engineer quality work and achieve student success that leaves a legacy on our campus and city.*

Meet the OSL Team

	**Patrick Fina, M.Ed.** *Director, Office of Student Life* pfina@illnoistech.edu | 312-567-5184 **Contact me for**: Staff Supervision, Student Government, Org Compliance, Engagement Strategies, General Advising
	**Sarah Hessasta** *Student Life Coordinator, Office of Student Life* shessasta@illinoistech.edu | 312-567-6979 **Contact me for**: Finance Board, Student Space Management & Supervision, Trainings, Programming, General Advising
	**Kat Hillock** *Student Life Coordinator, Office of Student Life* 312-567-3324 | khillock@illinoistech.edu **Contact me for**: Union Board, The Bog & MTCC (Programming), Reserving Space on Campus, CARES Team Support, General Advising

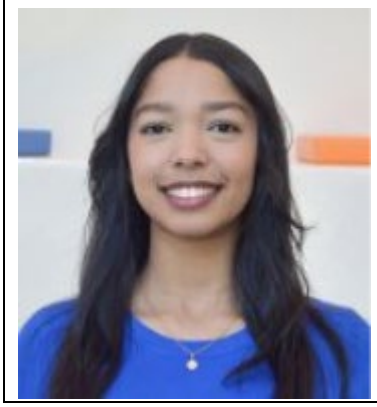
Student Staff



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Contact me for: Help navigating or getting on ***312*** or Buy It; need help thinking of creative ideas for events? I can do that, too.



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Student Organization – Definition and Recognition

What is a Student Organization?

Broadly speaking, a student organization is a group of students who organize around a shared interest, activity, project, etc. At Illinois Tech, we have a vibrant campus community that features over 115 officially recognized student organizations.

Student Organization Categories

All student organizations are assigned one of the following categories:

- Academic
- Arts and Media
- Community Service
- Cultural
- Faith and Spirituality
- Governance
- Hobbies and Special Interests
- Professional Organization
- Social
- Sports and Recreation
- VanderCook College of Music

Student Organization Requirements

To obtain official recognition and remain in good standing with Office of Student Life, all student organizations must:

- Host at least two events per semester, logged on the 312 platform
- Maintain an updated roster with at least seven active members
- Have a faculty/staff member serve as organization advisor
- Re-register the organization on an annual basis
- Comply with all university and Office of Student Life policies

Student Organization Privileges

Recognized organizations are eligible for a variety of support and services, including but not limited to:

- Ability to apply for funding from the Student Activities Fund
- The reservation of on-campus space for meetings and events
- General advising and support from the Office of Student Life
- Ability to advertise the organization and its events via the OSL newsletter, Campus Groups, and social media outlets
- Access to workshops offered by the Office of Student Life; topics include leadership development, financial management, event management and more
- Access to Student Organization Center supplies, Student Organization Storage, and Elevate Underground Lab

Student Organization Officer Requirements

Per the Illinois Tech student handbook, “representative officers of any student organization are held responsible for the group action of the organization to the fullest degree they are judged to have control of such action.” As such, “officers (appointed and elected) and executive board members of organizations must be regularly enrolled students in good academic and judicial standing.” Failure to comply with this policy will result in the intervention of the Office of Student Life.

Student Organization Conduct

The Illinois Tech student handbook states that “Illinois Tech expects student organizations, including fraternities and sororities, and their respective members to accept both personal and group responsibility for meeting recognized standards of good conduct. Organizations are expected to conduct their business in an honest, ethical fashion and to Student Handbook 83 cooperate with Illinois Tech officials as requested. Officers must accept responsibility for controlling organization events and ensure proper behavior of students and guests in attendance. Organizations shall operate in

accordance with (i) any policy, procedure, process or protocol, temporary or otherwise, that Illinois Tech may adopt, and (ii) any directive of an Illinois Tech official."

Additionally, "Illinois Tech reserves the right to hold both individuals and organizations, including fraternities and sororities, responsible for their actions. A student may be held individually responsible while, concurrently or consecutively, an organization may be held responsible for the same violation. The two processes are separate and independent."

New Student Organization Approval Process

During the first eight weeks of each semester, students can work with the Office of Student Life to finalize the documents required to create a new student club/organization. For the student club/org to be approved, an official proposal must be created, along with a constitution and sample budget. These documents will then be reviewed and approved/denied by the Student Government Association (SGA) during the second half of the semester. See below for a detailed overview of the process.

Initial Steps

1. Interested students should complete the Group Registration form on 312. This will allow the Office of Student Life to review the preliminary outline of your proposed student organization before scheduling an initial meeting. This initial meeting will serve as an opportunity for interested organizations to share the purpose and goals of the organization, and receive an overview of the Student Government Association process of approving new student organizations

2. Next, the interested student organization will work with the Office of Student Life to finalize their proposal. The proposal should be approximately 2-3 pages in length and should include the following:
    - Organization name
    - Purpose and Goals

- Constitution and/or Bylaws (see here for sample constitution)
- How the organization will benefit students
- How is the organization different from currently existing organizations
- How the organization plans to recruit members
- Current executive board members/structure
- List of programs and events
- At least seven interested students, including name, email address, major, and class year
- Potential advisor(s)
- Sample budget using the SGA preferred format (include a breakdown of budget categories, capped at a total of $4,000 per semester for their first two semesters)

Senate Review

Once all documents have been drafted, reviewed, and approved by the Assistant Director of Student Life, students must submit all relevant materials via the Potential New Student Organization review form by the Friday of the 8th week of the semester. The submitted documents will be reviewed by the SGA Executive Vice President. SGA will then spend the next two weeks reviewing proposals and contacting potential new student organizations with questions.

If, after the completion of the review period, SGA is satisfied with all proposal materials, it will approve the student organization at week 10 of the semester. If SGA cannot decide by vote to approve an organization, it will invite student representatives of said organization to present on behalf of the organization at a Senate meeting. A subsequent vote will take place in which an organization is either approved or denied outright.

Organization Approval

If approved, the SGA Executive Vice President will email each approved organization, notifying them of their status. A complete list of approved organizations and their

budgets will be sent to the Finance Board before week 11 and no later than week 12. The Finance Board will hold a hearing within a week of receiving a complete list of approved organizations to review the submitted budget requests from the newly approved organizations and the Finance Board will evaluate budget proposals based on the following:

- The organization's stated goals and activities
- Alignment with existing campus funding policies and the organization’s expected financial needs
- Compliance with university regulations and finance board policies
- Any additional financial context provided by the approved organizations if requested by the Finance Board.

Organization Denial

An organization is denied if during the Senate Hearing it receives a simple majority of votes to the negative. A senator may cast a denying vote for one of the following reasons.

- Duplicity of Existing Organization: The proposed organization duplicates the mission and activities of an existing organization.
- Unclear Mission/Vision: The mission and vision of the proposed organization are not clearly defined or articulated.

New Student Organization Step-by-Step Guide

STEP DESCRIPTION	ADDITIONAL INFO
1. Complete new student organization registration form.	Group Registration form

2. Create your proposal. The AD will work with you to ensure the document contains all necessary information.	Proposal Example
3. While you are working on your proposal, you should also create an example budget. SGA looks carefully at budgets before confirming an organization. Be as specific as possible when creating your budget. Note: New student organizations are limited to a maximum funding of $4,000 per semester for their first two semesters of existence.	Budget Example
4. Potential new student organizations should create a sample constitution as well. To receive your org funding, your constitution needs to be shared with the AD and approved by them.	Constitution Example
5. Once all documents have been approved, students must submit all relevant documents via the New Student Organization Request Form before the end of Week 8 of the semester.	Submit your documents here
6. As SGA is reviewing your documents, you may be asked to present at an SGA meeting. If required, create a presentation based on your proposal. Your presentation should be five minutes or less. After presenting you will have five minutes to answer questions.	Presentation Example

Contact any member of the Office of Student Life with any questions regarding the new student organization process.

Organization Re-Registration

During the Spring 2026 semester, the Office of Student Life implemented an annual student organization re-registration process, in which all groups, to remain active and officially recognized, must provide important information including, but not limited to:

- President's name and email
- Treasurer's name and email
- Faculty/staff advisor's name and email
- Current copy of group's constitution and/or bylaws
- And more

If organizations fail to complete re-registration by the stated deadline, they will be considered inactive and lose all privileges afforded to registered student groups. It is the responsibility of the organization's officers to complete the re-registration form by the deadline.

Fraternities and Sororities

Recognition and Expansion Policy

For over 100 years, Greek Letter Organizations have played a unique and important role in the lives of Illinois Tech students. The Office of Student Life continues to affirm the value that our 11 active chapters bring to our collegiate community. For those seeking to establish a new chapter, please consult the Illinois Tech Fraternity and Sorority Expansion Policy. New organizations must be approved first as a recognized student organization by Student Government Association, and then approved by Greek Council, to be considered an Illinois Tech fraternity/sorority chapter. Chapters cannot operate without being approved by both entities. If a chapter would like to recharter on Illinois Tech's campus, the chapter must be inactive for at least five years, and the chapter must get approval from the Dean of Students.

For questions or additional information, you can contact Patrick Fina (pfina@illinoistech.edu)

Certificate of Insurance Requirements

All Greek organization are required to provide their chapter's Certificate of Insurance (COI) on an annual basis as part of the Student Organization Re-Registration Process.

Events with Guest Lists

A Fraternity and Sorority event registration form must be submitted to the Office of Student Life no less than seven calendar days prior to the event. The event information will be forwarded to Public Safety. A complete guest list of attendees who must be submitted to the Office of Student Life no less than 48 hours prior to the event. A post-event guest list with signatures must be turned into the Office of Student Life before the end of the business day following the event. Visitors not listed on the approved guest list are not allowed to attend the event. Access to the house must be strictly controlled at all times, and those above 21 who are eligible to consume alcohol must be identified on entry by a different wristband or marking than students who are under 21. Both groups of students must wear their respective wristbands or markings throughout the party.

Organization events with guests in attendance are limited to an attendance maximum of two guests per active or new, initiated or alumni member attending the event. Guests are defined as any non-Illinois Tech students. An organization and its members are responsible for the actions of their guests at all times. Organizations wishing to have events that exceed the 2:1 guests per member ratio may propose to do so by contacting the Office of Student Life.

Student Organization Space & Storage

Dedicated Spaces and Offices

Student organizations may have offices and/or spaces on campus that have been allocated by facilities and/or an academic unit. All student organization spaces must be kept to the standards set forth by Illinois Tech facilities.

Student organization spaces must be utilized to further the mission of the organization and its membership. Student organization space allocations are reviewed annually. During annual re-registration, organizations will be asked to report on how the space was utilized.

Organizations that do not currently have a dedicated space may request one by submitting the dedicated space request form. These submissions are reviewed annually by facilities. Submitting a request does not guarantee a space, as it is extremely limited on campus.

Storage

Student organizations that purchase reusable items with SAF funding must keep those items in the storage areas located in the MTCC basement or in dedicated student organization space.

Some organizations may have storage space outside of the MTCC through designated spaces. The Office of Student Life does not have additional dedicated spaces to allocate to student organizations (please see above section).

Student organizations storing their belongings in the MTCC basement area need to adhere to the following guidelines:

- An organization's items must be stored in a container clearly labeled with the organization’s full name (and acronym if it applies) and email address.
    - The only exception will be if the item itself is too large to fit into a container. Oversize items will still need to be clearly labeled with the organization’s full name and email address.
    - If you need a clear plastic bin to store your items, please request it in your next Finance Budget

- All items belonging to an organization must be organized and situated together in the same vicinity.
- All contents must be clean, organized and accessible *(Ex. Loose colored pencils are tied together with a rubber band. Loose papers are clipped together with a paperclip. A decorative garland is tightly wrapped and protected for future use).*
- The storage area can only be accessed during the hours the Commons dining hall is open, with an escort of either an OSL staff member or a Welcome Desk employee.
- The President is responsible for maintaining an inventory of the items stored in the unit and will be responsible for submitting the inventory at the end of each academic semester.
- The storage area must be kept clean and organized.
- Student Organization Storage Space, and any organization offices/spaces, are not to be used for personal item storage. Any personal items that do not belong to the university may be removed.
- Items unaccounted for or improperly labeled at the end of the academic semester, will belong to the Office of Student Life and/or be discarded.
- Presidents and Treasurers can request access to the basement by filling out the Space Access Request form.

The following items are ***prohibited*** from being stored in the MTCC storage unit – no exceptions:

- Food and beverages – both opened and sealed
- Personal items of any organization member or otherwise
- Used napkins, utensils and other kitchen items
- Items broken beyond repair
- Lighters and other highly flammable materials
- Items already prohibited by the university

Failure to adhere to these rules will result in a loss of access to the MTCC storage unit and could lead to additional consequences for the organization itself.

Keys & Tap Access

Tap access to many student organization spaces may be requested through the tap access request form. Access is enabled for the academic year and expires on the last day of finals.

Some student organization spaces may have physical keys. It is the responsibility of the student organization to ensure keys are managed effectively through Student Life.

Keys are checked out to student organization leaders for the academic year and are due back to Student Life on the last day of finals.

Student Organization Systems

312 (aka CampusGroups)

312 is the centralized hub for all student organization operations and general campus engagement – it is available both on the web, as well as a mobile app. 312 has comprehensive tools available to student organization offices that include:

- Roster management
- Contact management
- Email and push notification management
- Event management
    - This includes room reservations, A/V requests, and all associated details
- Comprehensive surveys and forms
    - This includes a dedicated elections module, which can be customized to preserve the privacy of membership votes
- Customizable tracks and checklists for organization membership development
- Badges for specific organization achievements
- Service hours management

- Mentorship module and automated calendaring
- Public facing website modules
- Comprehensive budget management and spending tracking
- Inventory management

Buy It Overview

Illinois Tech uses an online purchasing system called Buy It. Organization treasurers and presidents are granted access to Buy It after completing required training provided by the Office of Student Life. Treasurers can make approved purchases on behalf of their organization or submit an expense claim (also known as a “reimbursement”). Purchases in Buy It should only be made following approval of a budget and its items from the Finance Board, and never for personal goods. BuyIt is used in partnership with 312 to ensure that all purchases are accounted for. After submitting a request in BuyIt, ensure to submit the payment request from the budget line that is funding the request!

BuyIt transactions are linked to your specific student organization account, often called a “FOAP” – which stands for “fund, organization, account, program.”

Treasurers can access Buy It in their Apps Dashboard. Presidents will also be granted Buy It access to assist Treasurers, if needed. All purchases should be re-assigned to Sarah Hessasta.

When purchasing items outside of Buy It, students must present the sales tax exemption form. ***Illinois Tech is a non-profit university and thus all purchases made for Illinois Tech are sales tax exempt. Students will not be reimbursed for sales tax.***

BuyIt is a university system, and student organization purchases follow the same approval queues as faculty/staff purchases. Depending on the vendor, dollar amounts, or contractual nature of a requisition, there is a minimum of levels of approval for all purchases, and often times, more than three.

Buy It: What Is an Expense Claim?

An expense claim (or reimbursement) is an out-of-pocket expense for an approved item from your budget (which was allocated by the Finance Board) that you are requesting a refund for.

Treasurers of student organizations submit a budget proposal, itemizing all the supplies needed for the semester, to the Finance Board. The Finance Board will review the proposal and determine what approval is. Based on what the Finance Board approves, the organization is then able to purchase those items within university policy requirements.

Anything approved on the budget approval ***that cannot be found on Buy It*** may be purchased externally and reimbursed. The Treasurer of the organization is the only person who can submit expense claims. The President may submit on occasion to assist the Treasurer. Reimbursements for vendors that exist in BuyIt can only be confirmed with prior, written approval from an OSL staff member.

When submitting a receipt on behalf of another student within the organization, you must ensure their name appears in the “On Behalf Of” drop down feature. If the student is not included in the dropdown box, please email Sarah Hessasta will the full name, Hawk email and A# of the student you wish to include in the dropdown feature. Once the student is successfully inputted into the dropdown feature, you may proceed with the expense claim submission.

The student must take a screenshot or photo of their receipt and ensure that it is shared with their treasurer as soon as possible. All receipts must include the name of the vendor, the date the items were purchased, a list of the items themselves and proof of payment, meaning it must show that the item was paid in cash or with a card. If it was paid with a card, the last four digits of the card would need to be on the receipt.

In the description box, you must write a brief (one sentence max) justification of the items purchased, along with the address of the person being reimbursed ***and*** whether or not they have direct deposit.

(Ex. Items for movie night. 123 Sesame St. Chicago, IL, 1001. John has direct deposit.)

All expense claims must be submitted **within 10 days of the date of purchase** in order to be processed. Failure to submit expense claims within the specified timeframe will result in the expense claim being denied.

You cannot submit expense claims for artists and vendors who visit campus. If the receipt is from an approved vendor in Buy It, you cannot submit a reimbursement unless granted specific approval by the Office of Student Life. If your organization is approved by a member of OSL to drive approved student travel, only the mileage can be reimbursed—not gas, car maintenance, etc. You cannot submit reimbursements for rentals cars or Ubers/Lyfts.

Note: Amazon & Home Depot are approved vendors within Buy It. However, any reimbursement for purchases from your personal Amazon account or from an in-person Home Depot store will be automatically denied.

Expense claims are limited to $500 total per person, per event. If an expense is more than $500, it must be placed through Buy It as a Requisition prior to the event, and not an expense claim. Expense claims for catering cannot exceed $300. Expense claims and requisitions cannot be generated retroactively.

Buy It: What Is a Requisition?

Requisitions are what carts in Buy It once approved by Student Life Coordinator, Sarah Hessasta. Requisitions are used to generate payment through Buy It to approved vendors and select punch-out catalogs.

Treasurers have access to create carts (which become requisitions) through Buy It. A detailed resource list showcasing the ways to create requisitions in Buy It can be found at this link.

Buy It: What Is a “PO” or “PE”?

Oftentimes, a Buy It vendor may ask a Treasurer for a “PO” or a “PO Number.” “PO” stands for “Purchase Order,” (at Illinois Tech we call POs “PEs”) which is a requisition

that has been fully approved and is ready for payment. If your vendor has questions about the Illinois Tech PO process, they can contact the Procurement Office directly through the information listed on their website.

Buy It: How Does My Vendor Get Paid?

When vendors are invited into Buy It, they can select how they would like to be paid. The system defaults to net-45, which means payment is generated 45 days from the date of the "PO". The vendor must manually select the alternative payment options we offer, which include net-30 and net-15. Net-15 is a virtual payment (which generates within two weeks) that requires the vendor to create a Finexio account with our Procurement office.

The vendor must select their payment preference when they sign up for the system.. Student Life cannot override what the vendor selects when they sign up.

It is imperative that you thoroughly communicate the payment expectations to the vendor ahead of time. Inquire about their payment preferences (Net-45, net-30, net-15) *before* submitting a requisition. This allows for Procurement to update the vendor's settings internally before a Purchase Order (PO) is generated. We cannot revise this retroactively.

Prior to creating a cart of any kind in Buy It, the vendor must be active and approved. Vendor approval can take approximately six weeks. If you anticipate spending more than $500 for any vendor cost, you must begin the process of adding them to Buy It a minimum of six weeks in advance.

Buy It Helpful Links

- Login to Buy It
- Buy It Training Video
- How to submit a reimbursement

    - Note: Expense claims must be submitted within 10 days of the purchase. If not, the expense claim may not be approved. Reimbursements can only be for current Illinois Tech (or Vandercook) students, faculty, and staff. Student Life cannot approve reimbursements for alumni, former students, or external entities for student organization expenses.
- Sales Tax Exemption Form
    - We recommend printing out this document when you are going to purchase items that cannot be found on Buy It. If a store asks for a phone number, you will need to share the following number = 312-567-3000

Additional information is included in the Student Organization Finances Section.

Payment Request Form

Immediately after a requisition or expense claim is submitted, the President or Treasurer must log that requisition or expense claim into the Payment Request Form in the 312 platform. This will log your anticipated expenses into the platform and automatically deduct from your approved budget once approved.

Requisitions and expense claims will not be approved unless they are logged through the payment form in 312.

Payment Request Form Helpful Links

- **Link to payment request form here**
-

Student Organization Travel: Concur

Illinois Tech uses Concur, a travel planning system, for all students/faculty/or staff traveling on behalf of the university. Student organizations must request travel arrangements in advance of their semesterly budget proposals for the Finance Board to approve. The Finance Board is inclined to cover the total cost of registration, transportation and lodging for a specific number of travelers. The approved travelers will then be ticketed for their conference attendance based on the total cost of the conference per person. The ticket must be paid for before travelling.

The Finance Board reserves the right to approve for only a select number of students to travel based on budget costs. ***The Finance Board must approve all travel arrangements.*** Once the Finance Board approves, the Treasurer may initiate the process of booking their travel arrangements through Concur.

Traveling students must complete the Dean of Students Travel Form ***and*** be approved ***before*** creating their account. 312 will guide student organization leadership through the necessary student travel steps.

Once a student completes their Concur training, they will complete the following steps:

- Select Profile from the top right-hand side > Profile Settings
- Select Personal Information and fill out all sections that are "Required", specifically
    - Mobile Phone, Country Calling Code (Mobile Phone), Gender, Date of Birth
- Assign organization Treasurer as the "Travel Assistant" so they can book travel on the students' behalf
- If you need help accessing Concur access, email Cate Parks (cparks5@iit.edu).

Additional information is included in the Student Organization Policies section under Travel Policies.

Email & Microsoft Teams

OTS manages bulk updates to student organization email access each summer. The bulk email updates automatically adds the same users into your student organization's Teams drive.

Additionally, your organization can use 312 to send communication to all members.

Papercut (Printing Account)

Student organizations who were approved by the Finance Board to receive printing funds will submit the payment request from their budget in 312, requesting a specific dollar amount be added to the organization's Papercut account. The Office of Student Life will connect with the necessary personnel in the Office of Technology Services to provide the printing allocations.

This does require cross-departmental communication, so please request printing funds at least two weeks in advance, when possible, of your desired promotional start date.

Finances

Finance Board

The Finance Board is a branch of the Student Government Association (SGA), responsible for allocating the Student Activity Fund (SAF) to all active student organizations on campus. The Finance Board is a student-led, spearheaded by a Finance Board Chair and Vice Chair, and guided by a staff-led advisor, the Student Life Coordinator.

Finance Board decisions are navigated in cooperation with university and Finance Board policies, which are reviewed and updated every academic year. Any active student can join the Finance Board during recruitment season.

Fiscal Year

Fall budgets will be submitted in August for review by the Finance Board and released in the weeks to follow. Spring budgets will be submitted in December/January and released in the weeks to follow.

The student organization fiscal year closes on the last day of classes for the Spring semester, and re-opens with the August budget submission process. These two funding periods are open to all organizations. Funds from the Student Activity Fee do not roll over to new fiscal years.

Budgets

Budget submissions will be reviewed by the Finance Board and released a few weeks afterwards. All budget submissions must adhere to the Finance Board policies.

A student organization will be assigned a designed Finance Board advisor following the semester's budget closure. This advisor will serve as a resource to your student organization through our budget review process that semester. It is expected that a Finance Board advisor will email an introduction to their assigned student organization, introducing themselves a scheduling and in-person or virtual meeting to review your budget.

This meeting is an opportunity to ask any questions, and for the advisor to request additional documentation or links for the Finance Board to appropriately review the submitted budget. Failure to submit all appropriate documentation requested of the Finance Board advisor may result in a failure for those items to be approved.

Suppliers/Vendor Requirements

Suppliers, also known as vendors, must be registered on Buy It in order for organizations to make purchases directly from their account. If an organization would like to add a supplier to Buy It, students may complete a form in Buy It to do so. A student may connect with their desired vendor, introducing themselves via email and requesting the essential information required for vendor submission. An email template to share with vendors can be found here.

IMPORTANT: It is essential that a student disclose the payment options the university offers to a vendor before any requisitions are submitted. It is ideal to communicate this information at this stage in the process.

If the supplier cannot be added, the organization will need to either identify another supplier or make the purchase using personal funds and submit paperwork to be reimbursed. Students should begin the process of adding a vendor in BuyIt, at least **6 weeks** prior to an event that requires payment by check. Vendors are approved by Procurement in the order that they are received.

For more detailed information, check out this tutorial video on how to add a supplier in Buy It.

Payments

Any payments made on behalf of a student organization must be an approved expense for that semester's budget submission by the Finance Board.

Requisitions

- Please ensure you submit your BuyIt requests as soon as possible.
- Student Life processes requisitions and expense claims in the order that they are received.
- For punch-out catalog requests (i.e. Amazon, CDW-G, Home Depot), OSL requests a minimum of two weeks of processing time prior to your intended order arrival date.
- Any requisitions that are not a punch-out catalog request will require an invoice in its submission. Proforma invoices and quotes are not the same as an invoice and will not be accepted
    - A quote is an estimated initial offer. A proforma invoice is like a quote, but a more detailed estimated cost before a sale is finalized.
- Only Treasurers can submit reimbursements. Presidents receive similar training so they can be of assistance during busy periods.
- Reimbursements cannot exceed $500 per person, per event**– *no exceptions.***
    - ***This includes mileage reimbursement for approved alternative modes of transportation***
- We cannot reimburse Amazon or Home Depot expenses**– *no exceptions.***
- If a vendor is on BuyIt, purchases should be through the requisition process.
    - *If you would like to seek an expense claim for a vendor that is active on BuyIt, you will need to have written approval from the Office of Student Life that you are approved to purchase outside of the requisition process.*
- Reimbursements must be submitted within 10 days following the event.

- Reimbursements may be submitted by the Treasurer for an expense incurred by another student organization member. The member must be a current student of Illinois Tech or VanderCook, and may ***not*** be an external advisor.
- If a student organization is receiving a discount by purchasing multiple tickets at one time, the following must be followed to receive a reimbursement:
    - Students must contact the OSL office to set up an online ticket store. Students will pay their share to the online ticket store.
    - One student may pay for all of the tickets and submit a reimbursement for the amount that was covered by the SAF.
        - **IMPORTANT:** Students should not be collecting money from other students and then reimbursing them at a later time. These requests will automatically be denied, and no student will be reimbursed.

Expense Claims

Members of student organizations can purchase items for their organization using their own personal funds and be reimbursed, *only if it was approved for their budget in BuyIt.* ***Reimbursements cannot exceed $500 per student, per event– no exceptions. Reimbursements for catering cannot exceed $300.***

If any student makes a purchase using their personal funds on behalf of a student organization, they should submit an Expense Claim on Buy It **within 10 days of the purchase**. In order to be reimbursed students must ensure that they provide receipts for all purchases they are seeking reimbursement for. Reimbursement can take approximately sixty (60) days from the time of submission. In most cases, the reimbursement will come in the form of a check mailed to the student at the mailing address they provide in the reimbursement submission. For those that have direct deposit, you are still required to share an updated address on your reimbursement form. Students can use the following document for step-by-step instructions on how to submit a reimbursement.

For purchases made in the Fall semester (August-December), students must submit their reimbursement no later than December 20th. For purchases made in the Spring semester (January-May), students must submit their reimbursement before May 1st. Reimbursements submitted late will automatically be denied and the student will not be reimbursed.

Concur Charges

All travel and accommodation for the conference must be booked through Buy It and Concur by the Treasurer and approved by the Student Life Coordinator. The Student Life Coordinator must be notified at least 48 business hours ahead of any booking because there is a time restriction for how long travel items can sit in the queue for approval. More than two submissions without approval will result in late fees the organization will be responsible for paying.

Event Charges

To assist with budgeting for an event, see the table below for a list of common charges added to student organization events. University policy requires fees to be added to large scale and/or after-hours events. These fees should be taken into account when submitting your budget to the Finance Board. **OSL cannot remove or discount the costs of staffing, work orders, and/or equipment set by the university.**

Note: This is not the full list of potential charges and was last updated in January 2024. Prices are subject to change. Final estimates are reflected on your space reservation confirmation sheet.

Charge	Estimated Cost	Comments
Staffing: Public Safety	$50 per hour, minimum of 4 hours • 50-100 attendees = 1 officer	Required if 50 guests or more and/or if open to outside guests are attending (regardless of size)

	• 100-150 = 2 officers • 150-200 = 3 officers	
Staffing: Janitorial	$40 per hour, minimum of 4 hours	Required if there are 50 guests or more, and anytime food is being served at an event outside of the university's janitorial hours
Staffing: AV Tech	$22 per hour	Required for any event in MTCC or Hermann Hall using audio/visual systems
Staffing: Extended Staffing	$20 per hour EX: Saturday event in Hermann Hall starting at 5PM-8PM -> charged from 3PM-8PM.	Required if in MTCC or Hermann Hall for each hour outside of the event hours ∉ Monday-Friday 8am-8pm ∉ Sat-Sunday 9am-3pm
Staffing: Dedicated Event Staff	$20 per hour	Required for support in pre-setup or during event, rare to add
Equipment: Chairs, tables, coatrack	No Charge if inside Rental charge (varies) for outside events	Outside equipment requires at minimum 2 week notice.
Equipment: Power strip	$12.00 per power strip(minus 75% discount) = $3.00	
Equipment: Wireless Microphone	$90.00 per microphone(minus 75% discount) = $22.50	
Linens	$7.00 per linen (minus 75% discount) = $1.75 per linen	
Classrooms	Free	Cost effective reservation, students able to use pre-existing equipment at no charge
Classroom Auditoriums	Free (without food)	Cost effective reservation, students able to use pre-existing equipment at no

		charge ** Please note: if food is brought in and a mess is made, janitorial will be required for all future reservations in the auditorium
MTCC / Hermann Hall / Bog Space	Free	Free for the space, but can become costly due to equipment/staffing needs
Kaplan	Varies	Requires approval from Kaplan and OSL to reserve space, various costs included based on needs

Note: Failure to acknowledge these mandated fees in the budget submission will result in a deduction from approved budget costs or a reimbursement from the student organization during the following semester.

Chartwells Charges

The Office of Student Life encourages students to utilize Chartwells catering when placing food orders. As they are with Illinois Tech, the amount charged will automatically be taken out of your student organization account. Students have their own catering menu they can choose items from.

If you are interested in catering from an external vendor in the MTCC or Hermann Hall, you will need to indicate this and provide all the necessary documentation in the event form from 312. If you would like to begin this process in advance, please contact Student Life Coordinator Katherine Hillock, a khillock@iit.edu.

Access the Carved & Crafted Student Catering Menu

Fundraising and Donations

Fundraising

Fundraising is a great option for organizations who are looking to supplement the funding they receive from the Student Activity Fund.

Students cannot use SAF money to purchase items to sell for fundraisers. All extra profit must be submitted to the Student Life Coordinator to be deposited into your account. Treasures are responsible for keeping a record of all outside funds received. We recommend that this is listed in your detailed ledger.

Small Scale Fundraising

This would include selling items on the bridge to students/staff/faculty, organizing a car wash, selling t-shirts, etc. These events would be accepting smaller donations at the time of the event. The Office of Student Life can create an online ticket store on the 312, to collect money electronically. Students must email the Student Life Coordinator, Sarah Hessasta (shessasta@iit.edu), a minimum of one week prior to when they need the ticket store available. In their email, they must include the following:

- Name of fundraiser
- Cost of the item(s) to purchase
- How many of each item is for sale
- Date the store needs to be open
- Date the store should close
- Email address of treasure to be notified of purchases and keep track of funds
- Image to include on the store for students to see (must be jpeg or png format - 800x800 pixels)

If students are collecting cash or checks, checks should be made out to “Illinois Institute of Technology” to be able to be deposited. All cash and checks collected should be placed in an envelope labeled with the name of the organization, their 6-digit Fund Number, and the total balance of cash and checks that are enclosed. The envelope should be delivered to the Student Life Coordinator Sarah Hessasta to be deposited into

the organization's account. ***The coordination of a check drop off with Sarah Hessasta should be done in advance. Do not slip any checks under any office doors.***

Students cannot bring in any homemade goods (i.e. cookies, brownies, etc.) as it is a food safety hazard. If students would like to sell baked goods, they can purchase pre-made items from bakeries/grocery stores or contact Chartwells to receive baked goods.

Chartwells does provide a 40% discount on baked items for fundraisers. If students are selling items from a bakery/grocery store in McCormick Tribune Campus Center or Hermann Hall, they must complete the Outside Food Form and receive approval from Student Life and Chartwells before they can sell any food. We ask that the form be submitted one week prior to your fundraising date.

Large Scale Fundraising

Large contributions, asking for alumni/company donations/sponsorship, etc.

All large-scale fundraising must go through the Office of Advancement to ensure we are following policy/procedure for these requests for a non-profit university. Any fundraising from individuals outside of the university requires approval from Institutional Advancement. To begin this process, please contact Joe Volin (jvolin@iit.edu) a minimum of 90 days prior to the intended fundraising date.

In your initial email, students should have created a proposal that includes the following:

- Mission of the student organization:
- What they need funding for:
    - Project / Event / Etc. Explain what it is, who is involved, how it benefits students (learning outcomes)
- What they are looking for help with:
    - Money (total amount needed), Prizes (like t-shirts, water bottles, etc.), etc, sponsorship of event

- Benefits for alumni/companies to donate (advertise their company in marketing materials, space to table at the event to meet with IIT students, etc.)

Students can reach out to the Student Life staff for initial assistance in creating their proposal. If your fundraising proposal is part of an event, the event form on 312 will prompt you for the additional information required to evaluated your request from Advancement.

Donations

If anyone is writing a check, they need to make out a check payable to “Illinois Institute of Technology.” This check should be placed in an envelope labeled with the name of the organization and the amount of the donation. The envelope should then be delivered to the Student Life Coordinator, Sarah Hessasta (shessasta@illinoistech.edu), to be deposited into the organization’s account. ***The coordination of a check drop off with Sarah Hessasta should be done in advance. Do not slip any checks under any office doors.***

The Office of Student Life will input the donation received into the organization’s approved budget for that semester in The 312. It will be a budgetary item that will carry over until utilized.

Membership Dues

Organizations may charge membership dues to active members of their organization. These dues must be properly communicated to any active or prospective members of the organization. The dues must have a clear purpose to benefit the organization and must not be an unreasonable or excessive amount. If your organization would like to charge membership dues, a member of the executive board should set up a meeting with the Coordinator of Student Life Sarah Hessasta to discuss the membership amount. If the dues are found to be appropriate and justified, the Office of Student Life will set up an online store for members to pay their dues. The Treasure of your

organization will be notified via email each time a member pays their dues and is responsible for keeping track of the total amount of dues collected during the academic year.

Contract Requirements

When a student organization is approved to bring a performer or service to campus, any contracts must be reviewed and signed by the vendor and the university.

Students are not authorized to sign a contract under any circumstance.

All contracts must be requested and signed at least six weeks in advance through the contract signature request form; once signed, they must be attached to the submitted requisition in BuyIt.

Contracts may include, but are not limited to:

- Catering Rider
- Bus Rider
- Artist Agreement
- Agreement for Consulting Services

All template contracts provided by the university are linked in the contract review form.

Processing Times

A new university policy was instilled in July 2025 requiring that contracts only be signed by specific university signatories **at least six weeks in advance.** The Office of Student Life is not able to independently sign contracts outside of this process.

If contracts are not provided within the required timeframe, they will not be processed.

Events

All events for your organization (including e-board meetings, practices, etc.) must be submitted and approved on 312. 75% of all attendees must be current students.

Small Events

Small events are defined as any events that are 50 people or fewer, will be attended by only Illinois Tech and VanderCook students, and/or requires a space on-campus “as is,” meaning the event does not require any additional equipment (AV, tables, chairs, etc.)

added to the space. Small events can typically be processed with a two week notice. For requests that utilize the MTCC Color or P-Club Conference rooms with no setup or A/V, OSL can typically process those within two business days.

Large Events

Recorded attendance may be required by Finance Board to justification costs associated with a Large-scale event.

Large events are defined as any events that are:

- More than 50 guests
- Open to the public (non-IIT/Vandercook students, staff, and faculty)
- Has extensive AV / equipment needs
- Considered a gala / banquet / performance
- Requires multiple rooms to be reserved
- Requests large spaces on campus (HH/MTCC Auditorium, Ballroom)

Large events are produced in partnership with Event Services, and typically require a minimum of four weeks lead time to ensure all details are confirmed.

Minors on Campus

If a student organization wishes to bring minors on campus for an event, this requires explicit communication with the Office of Student Life via the event submission tool in 312 at least six weeks in advance.

An Illinois Tech staff or faculty member must be involved in communication, asserting full responsibility for the oversight and management of the event. An Illinois Tech student cannot serve in this role in any capacity.

Waivers must be distributed and signed by the parents/guardians of all the minors in attendance.

Conferences & Competitions

Student organizations traveling to local or out-of-state conferences or competitions must be approved by the Finance Board. Supporting documents and links to the conference registration, preferred travel and lodging items, etc. must be attached to your ledger for consideration.

Per the Illinois Tech Student Handbook, a chaperone is required for all student travel. A full time Illinois Tech staff or faculty member constituted an appropriate chaperone for the trip. The Office of Student Life will handle the chaperone's registration, lodging and transportation.

The SAF will cover registration, lodging and transportation in full, and travelers will be required to pay a ticket for their attendance before traveling. The ticket cost will be finalized by the Finance Board based on the total cost of the trip per person. The most cost-efficient option must be selected for transportation.

All travel and accommodation for the conference must be booked through Buy It and Concur by the Treasurer. Conference registration must be purchased through Buy It unless given explicit approval by the Office of Student Life. Students will not be reimbursed for conference registration unless explicitly granted approval by the Office of Student Life.

Students will not be reimbursed for Uber/Lyft or food. The SAF will not cover rental cars. Travelers approved to drive by the Office of Student Life can submit for a mileage reimbursement ($0.78 per mile), but it cannot exceed $500.

Timeline:

- Several months out: The organization will seek out their advisor or another willing staff or faculty member to accompany the student organization on their trip.
- Several Months out: Treasurer will submit budget. The Finance Board will fund a conference/competition in full; registration, transportation and lodging, but the number of travelers allowed to travel will fluctuate. The conference/competition will be ticketed. Advisors can connect with the Student Life Coordinator to book their individual travel.

- 75-60 days out: All students will submit a Dean of Students (DoS) Travel Form upon budget approval . ***Treasurers must wait for DoS approval before any bookings can be made or approved. Remember, there is a fee for concur submissions that are canceled.***
- After DoS Approval: Student leaders will be invited into a formal Student Travel Checklist that starts with a meeting with Sarah Hessasta.
- 45 days out: Student leaders will schedule a meeting with Sarah Hessasta to establish an formal registration for the approved conference/competition. Students will be eld through the Travel Checklist that includes Concur registration, travel booking and ticketing.
- ***Conference will now be ticketed. Tickets must be purchased before travel but the allotted deadline. Debts not paid will result in the student not traveling.***

Outdoor Events

Firepits

In Fall 2025, OSL worked with Facilities to retrofit the two existing firepits in Farr Field and the Greek Quad to meet City of Chicago requirements. When submitting an event, you may request the firepits through 312. To use a firepit, they will need to be unlocked by Public Safety, who will also need to oversee the lighting of the firewood.

Catering & Food

Chartwells is our food provider at Illinois Tech.

Pursuant with the contract process of the university, any external food should be procured through the catering rider and contract process. To support flexibility for student organizations, the below thresholds have been developed for student organization catering.

Under $300: Can be purchased on a personal card, with a corresponding expense claim for reimbursement.

Over $300: Can be purchased from an external catering company/restaurant through a catering contract with advance approval from both OSL and Chartwells; or can be purchased directly from Chartwells.

Regardless of dollar amount, the MTCC and Hermann Hall require Chartwells.

Events with Alcohol

Events with alcohol are evaluated with the highest level of scrutiny. You may indicate that your event will potentially contain alcohol within your event submission in 312. Events with alcohol require multiple signatures and documentation to be on file with multiple offices.

Events with External Guests

Many other areas of the university work with alumni, external companies, and local non-profits. When submitting your events on 312, ensure to mark all of the potential external guests you will have in attendance.

As a reminder, for student organization events, 75% of attendees must be current students.

Off-Campus Events

All events, regardless of whether they take place on campus or off campus, must be registered on Campus Groups. If you are going off campus, you must provide a specific address and/or location name.

Religious Events

There are specific spaces on campus that are approved for worship services. While we will do our best to accommodate all requests, worship services must be in an university approved location.

Ticketed Events

312 is able to track attendance through a ticketing module. If Finance Board requires you to ticket your event, all tickets must be sold and managed through 312.

Waivers

Events with inherent risk will require the Illinois Tech Assumption of Risk and Release. This waiver is now able to be automatically applied to your organization events. To apply the waiver, select “waivers” on the event creation page, and select the one titled Assumption of Risk and Release.

Processing Times

Student Life processes request in the order that they are received. Academic spaces cannot be released until after the add/drop period.

Marketing

Email

Student organizations are provided with email addresses from OTS. While these can be managed through the shared inbox feature of Outlook, organizations can also utilize the Email module in 312. The email module will send a message to all members and/or contacts on your group.

Social Media

Student Organizations may host social media accounts. The student code of conduct still applies to social media if it is being used as a registered student organization.

Communication Tools (i.e. Discord)

If organizations choose to utilize tools outside of the Illinois Tech ecosystem (i.e. Discord, Slack, etc.), they are still subject to the student code of conduct. The university has provided 312 (which includes a forum) and Teams as options to utilize that exist within the university's Single Sign On ecosystem.

If utilizing Slack/Discord, student organizations are encouraged to have an application to join a server or channel where a student's username can be verified to confirm they are a member of the Illinois Tech community.

MTCC Windows

Student organizations that would like to decorate the windows on the MTCC Bridge must fill out the space reservation form at least one week in advance from the time they wish to paint. All requests are reviewed on a case-by-case basis. Generally, only window painting that advertises an event or conveys the organization's mission, purpose, or logo will be approved.

Postings that, in the opinion of Illinois Tech, are deemed to be offensive, indecent, or oppressive to others or that are incompatible with the educational mission or legal obligations of Illinois Tech are prohibited as are postings that contain material inconsistent with copyright, trademark and other such laws.

Once confirmed by OSL staff, the student organization has permission to visit the MTCC Welcome Desk to check out window painting materials, and cleaning equipment if needed.

Tables on the MTCC Bridge

Organizations are permitted to reserve an MTCC Bridge table as a platform to distribute flyers, giveaways, etc. and discuss information relevant to the organization's mission and purpose.

Organizations wishing to convey messages that may be perceived as politically charged, potentially controversial, or confrontational may be granted approval to reserve a bridge table but must agree to convey their messages verbally or in written form and must remain present to discuss and defend their perspectives. Such written materials may not be posted on the windows or left unattended when organization members are not present.

Flyers

Student organizations wishing to display posters on campus must first have all flyers reviewed and approved by the Office of Student Life. Generally, only posters and flyers that advertise an event or convey the organization's mission and purpose or logo will be approved. In order to receive approval for your poster, the following criteria must be met:

- Name of student organization/logo
- Name of the event
- Location of the event
- Time and date of the event
- Email address or contact information
- States "SAF Funded," if applicable
- Mention of any co-sponsors of the event, if applicable

- Any other relevant details about the event, if applicable

To receive the Office Student Life stamp, students must visit the MTCC Welcome Desk, located on the northwest side of the building. Our student staff will verify that the poster has the required information for posting (see above) and provide students with an approval stamp. In the MTCC, posters can only be hung on the “authorized posting” pillars and reserved MTCC windows.

When taping posters in the residence halls, please visit the Office of Residence Life front desk, located in McCormick Student Village (MSV), to provide you with the appropriate type of tape. Students must use blue painter tape when hanging posters around campus. Posters hung using other tape will be removed. If unapproved tape is used and causes damage, the organization may be responsible for cleaning and/or repair costs.

Note: Posters that have not received the approval stamp, that are hung in undesignated posting areas, and/or posters that share misleading/incorrect information will be taken down immediately.

Projects

The following policy has been created for our student organizations who are using their funding for projects that involve heavy machinery, chemicals, and/or any form of construction of an item. The following steps must be taken for an organization to be able to make any purchase for their project. Student organizations that fail to follow these rules will be temporarily inactive while undergoing a review by the Judicial Board and Dean of Students.

1. Students submit their budget to Finance Board requesting SAF by the deadline
2. Students complete and submit the following documentation to the OSL office through the submission form on 312.

a. Completed Assumption of Risk and Release Waiver submitted to OSL for all students involved in the project
b. Materials Overview
    i. Students will need to provide an overview explaining what they need the materials for, when they plan to begin the project, faculty/staff involved in the project, and where they will be completing the project.
c. Google sheet with all students (include name, email and A#) involved in the planning/building phase. This will need to include the name and email of faculty/staff consulted for the project and the student organization advisor.
    i. **Please note:** This includes any student onsite at any point during the construction even if they aren't actively building. These students should have the tag “non-builder” next to their name
d. Construction plans
    i. Drawings with information on the materials to be used and the physical construction plans (detail views)
    ii. Providing an execution plan (ex: first we will connect material A and material B via #10 screws, etc)
        1. Must include their schedule (on this day we cut all the wood, next day we assemble ...) and construction process for Facilities to review
e. Training is required for all students participating in the project. Students who have completed other safety training (Idea Shop, etc.) are **still required** to attend training by Facilities.
        1. Any new students who join the project late must complete training before engaging in the project
        2. Students will need to complete training once a year to be involved in projects. If a student completed training with one organization, but is involved in a project with another

organization, they do not need to attend training again as long as it has been less than a year that they were trained.

3. Once Facilities reviews documentation and approves, SAF would then be officially approved to be used on that project. Students are not able to purchase any materials until receiving this official approval. Students are not able to begin building until training has been completed.

If the same project is being worked on and does not get completed within the school year, the same requirements will need to be followed to share updates. See below for specifics:

On-Going/Extended Projects

For projects that are not completed by the end of the academic year, the students will need to submit the following documentation:

- Completed Assumption of Risk and Release Waiver submitted to OSL for all students involved in the project (returning and new students)
- **Updated** materials list
    - *Students will update the document used last year.*
- **Updated** information with all students (include name, email and A#) involved in the building phase. This will need to include all faculty/staff consulted for the project and student organization advisor contact information (name and email address)
    - *Students will update the document used last year*
- **Updated** construction plan

Advisors

The Office of Student Life extends a tremendous thank you to all of our student organization advisors for their hard work and dedication. Without your help, supporting our 130+ student organizations would not be possible.

Note: Beginning in Fall 2025, the Office of Student Life asks that faculty/staff members serve as the advisor to no more than two organizations at the same time.